



Procession bowl
This lekythos, a type of shallow dish, is decorated with a scene of half-man, half-goat satyrs in a procession in honor of Bacchus, the god of wine.

modern-looking grater



Ancient grater
Cheese played an important part in the Roman diet. Graters such as this one were invented to allow cheese to be used as a topping on other foodstuffs.



Amphora
The Romans transported liquid goods such as oil and wine in amphoras, a type of large, double-handled storage jar.



flask containing oil

strigil for scraping

Bathing tools
At the baths, a Roman's skin was oiled and then scraped to remove sweat and dirt. A ring was used to transport the tools.

Short sword
The Roman military sword, or *gladius*, had a short blade—ideal for attacks at close range. It was used by soldiers and some gladiators.



short blade

ivory grip

Military javelin
Each Roman legionary carried two of these *pila* (javelins). The javelin's iron head was designed to break off on impact to prevent an opponent throwing it back.



long iron shank

handle shaped for throwing



Imperial coins
Coins bearing the head of the current emperor (here Augustus and Claudius) acted as powerful propaganda tools across the empire, showing even the masses an image of their ruler.

Proof of citizenship
Noncitizens who served 25 years in the Roman army were awarded citizenship and given bronze diplomas such as this one to record the grant.



Latin text



extended neck plate

gridded visor to protect face

Gladiator helmet
Roman gladiators bore a variety of arms and armor. This sort of helmet was worn by a Thracian, a type of gladiator whose equipment was modeled on that of ancient Thracian warriors.



Sling pellets
Roman legionaries normally relied on their swords, but auxiliary light infantry used other weapons to devastating effect, such as these metal sling pellets.

small size would have offered little protection

Bronze gladiator shield
Thracian gladiators—a class of lightly armed gladiator—carried lightweight, round shields such as this one for defense, and a scimitar, with a short, curved blade, to attack their opponents.

